“Netflix” for Lucid Dreams: can preselected narrative cues during REM guide lucid dream content?

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Introduction and motivation

Can we script our dreams? The phenomenon of the external world seeping into our dreams is widely recognized, with particular success for **dream-relevant auditory stimuli**[1]. Recent dream research suggests that we can use learned cues during sleep to induce lucid dreaming, and then have **real-time communication with lucid dreamers**[2]. This communication was reported to influence some participants’ dreams.



Methods

Experimental design

Paradigm: Queue up dream narratives, induce lucidity during REM, play dream narratives.

Queue → Sleep → Lucidity Induction → Dream Narrative

Analysis approach

Participants will complete the following for pre- and post-intervention comparisons.

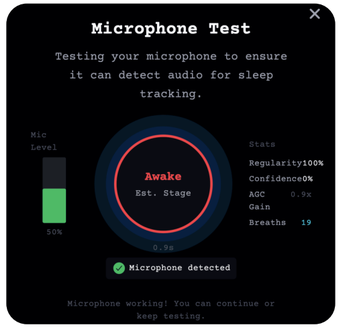
- **Dream Reports**: Voice memo recorded upon wake
- **Cognition**: Battery of cognitive performance measures, knowledge mapping tasks
- **Well-being**: Mood and anxiety inventories, health self-assessments

Mobile Application

Dream Narrative Selection



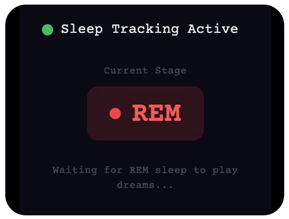
Guided Dreaming





Connect Wearables & Test Microphone

Lucidity Induction



You find yourself standing at the entrance to a garden … a low stone archway covered in flowering vines frames the path ahead … **Take a moment to look at your hands.** See how they glow with gentle light … **This is how you know you are dreaming.** You are aware. You are safe. And this garden has been waiting for you, cultivated through centuries of peaceful nights … [PAUSE]

Discussion

Key questions

- **Question 1:** Can we guide dream content (especially during this consciousness-privileged dream state)?
- **Question 2**: Can guided dream content boost creativity, reduce anxiety, or improve skills?
- **Question 3**: How much pre-sleep lucidity training is necessary for successful lucidity induction?

Limitations

- Highly **dependent on wearable data** — how can we improve audio-only sleep staging?
- Successful lucidity induction likely requires **pre-sleep training** with cues[3].

Planned features

- Train eye/breath response for **lucidity confirmation** (calibrate using wearable sensors pre-sleep).
- Narrative **customization** (e.g., turn a targeted skill into a dream narrative so you can practice in your sleep).

References

1. Salvesen *et al.* (2024). *Sleep Med. Rev.* **2.** Konkoly *et al.* (2021). *Curr. Bio.* **3.** Konkoly *et al.* (2024). *Consc. & Cog.*

Resources

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Code: github.com/ContextLab/dream-stream | **Web App:** context-lab.com/dream-stream